TRT 13

Nandrolone

Synthetic anabolic steroid related to testosterone; the decanoate ester is an oily injection into muscle



CLASS	STUDIED FOR	HUMAN EVIDENCE	US STATUS
Anabolic steroid	Kidney anemia, muscle loss	Controlled human trials	Not marketed in the US (approval withdrawn)

STUDIED FOR

Kidney anemia	Muscle on dialysis	HIV weight loss
HUMAN	HUMAN	HUMAN

No US product is marketed. Deca-Durabolin was approved in 1962; FDA withdrew the application in Dec 2024 at the maker's request.

HOW IT WORKS IN THE BODY

Nandrolone → Androgen receptor → Red cells, protein → Lean mass

- **Label:** anabolic and androgenic effects have never been fully separated
- **Label:** suppresses pituitary signals to the testes; may act on the testis
- **Approved use:** raised hemoglobin and red cell mass in kidney failure

EVIDENCE & WHAT'S KNOWN

EVIDENCE

CONTROLLED TRIALS
LEVEL 4 OF 5

- Approved 1962, before modern trial rules
- Small RCTs: dialysis (29, 79 people), HIV
- Trials ran 12 weeks to 6 months

NOT YET ESTABLISHED

- Long-term outcomes in RCTs
- Half-life in people
- Survival effects on dialysis

QUICK PRACTICAL INFO

HALF-LIFE	ROUTES STUDIED
Not established (not on the label)	Injection into muscle
PHARMACOKINETICS	**SOLD AS**
Not established (label gives no data)	Not available in the US; Schedule III
MONITORED IN TRIALS	**SPORT (WADA)**
Hemoglobin, hematocrit, lipids, liver tests (label)	Prohibited, class S1

REGULATORY

FDA	Approval withdrawn Dec 2024; all discontinued
DEA	Schedule III anabolic steroid
WADA	Prohibited at all times (S1)

REFERENCES

1. FDA, nandrolone decanoate injection label (Watson), Feb 2007
2. Federal Register, 89 FR 91410, withdrawal of 26 drug applications, Nov 2024
3. WADA, 2026 Prohibited List

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